

Ornamental fish imported to Australia undergo a mandatory post-arrival quarantine period. The fish are isolated at a registered Class 7.1 Approved Arrangement (AA) site. This applies to both freshwater and marine ornamental fish.

Only approved chemicals, treatments, and antibiotics can be used on imported ornamental fish during quarantine.

Importers and AA Site Operators must comply with all state and territory regulations.

Approved chemical lists

We provide 2 lists of approved chemicals (treatments or antibiotics) for ornamental fish. The first is for marine and freshwater ornamental fish, excluding goldfish. The second is for goldfish as well as marine and freshwater ornamental fish.

The lists act as pre-approval for use during post-entry isolation. We review and approve all chemicals before they are added to the list.

For marine and freshwater ornamental fish

Table 1 lists the chemicals approved for use on marine and freshwater ornamental fish.

This list of chemicals in Table 1 are excluded for use on goldfish.

Table 1: Chemicals for use on marine and freshwater ornamental fish (excluding goldfish)

Common name	Alternative names	Active ingredients
Acriflavine	Euflavine	
Amoxicillin	Amoxycilin	
Benzalkonium chloride		
Doxycycline		
Enrofloxacin	Baytril	
Erythromycin		
Ick guard		Malachite Green and Acriflavine
Multicure		Malachite Green, Methylene Blue, and Acriflavine
Parasite guard		Praziquantel, Diflubenzuron, Metronidazole, and Acriflavine
Peracetic acid		
Spectovet		

Sulphadiazine	Lincomycin Hydrochloride and Spectinomycin sulphate
Terramycin	Oxytetracycline hydrochloride
Tetracycline	
Trimethoprim	
Triple Sulpha	Sodium sulfathiazole, Sodium sulfamethazine, and Sodium sulfacetamide

Chemicals safe for goldfish

Some approved treatments are not safe to use on goldfish (*Carassius auratus*). This is to manage the risk of:

- masked clinical signs, and
- interference with accurate disease diagnosis.

Antibacterial treatments must not be used on goldfish, unless approved by us.

The chemicals in Table 2 are for use on goldfish. They can also be used on other marine and freshwater ornamental fish.

Table 2: Chemicals, treatments and antibiotics for use on marine and freshwater ornamental fish (including goldfish)

Common name	Alternative names	Active ingredients
Aquasonic Ichonex		Copper sulphate and Malachite Green
Aquasonic Oodonex		Copper sulphate
Aquasonic Paragone		Trichlorophon, sodium chloride, magnesium stearate
Bactonex		Methylene blue, Aminacrine hydrochloride
Blackwater Extract	Water conditioner	
Calcium carbonate		
Calcium chloride		
Chloromon		
Copper		

Copper salts		
Copper sulphate		
De-los	Dylox treatment	
Dimetridazole		
Dipterex		Trichlorfon
Disodium phosphate		
Fenbendazole		
Formaldehyde	Formalin	
Hydrochloric acid		
Hydrogen Peroxide		
Ivermectin		
Levamisole		
Magnesium sulphate		
Malachite Green	Victoria Green, Aniline Green	
Methylene Blue		
Monosodium Phosphate		
Phosphoric acid		
Potassium Permanganate		
Praziquantel		
Quinine Sulphate		
Rift Lake Conditioning Salts		
Seachem Cupramine		Copper sulphate
Sodium Bi-carbonate		
Sodium chloride	Sea salt	
Sodium hypochlorite	Bleach	
Sodium thiosulphate		
Tea Tree Oil	Melafix	
Trichlorfon		
Conditioning salts		
White Spot Remedy		Formaldehyde, Malachite Green

Care of fish in quarantine

The biosecurity industry participant (BIP) is responsible for fish during the mandatory post-arrival quarantine period.

They must:

- Use chemicals according to the manufacturer's direction (or veterinary prescription).
- Comply with Approved Arrangement Class 7.1 Conditions, including:
 - recognised aquatic animal husbandry practices
 - training for anyone handling biosecurity-controlled items, and
 - a contingency plan for unexpected events that may compromise biosecurity.

Chemicals not on the list

If it's not on the list, you cannot use it unless you have both:

- a written veterinarian diagnosis or prescription, and
- approval from us.

How to add a chemical

If you want a chemical added to the list, email your request to imports@aff.gov.au.

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/biosecurity-trade/import/goods/live-animals/importing-live-fish-aus/approved-treatments>